

Allen Ace

Remote

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Dear Hiring Manager,

I am writing to express my interest in cybersecurity opportunities within your organization, particularly in Security Operations (SOC), Threat Detection, Threat Hunting, Digital Forensics & Incident Response (DFIR), Malware Analysis, or Detection Engineering.

Over the past year, I have focused on developing practical, investigation-driven cybersecurity skills through hands-on projects that simulate real-world incident response and malware investigations. Rather than simply learning security tools, I have built a portfolio that demonstrates how to investigate incidents, correlate evidence across multiple data sources, map adversary behavior to the MITRE ATT&CK framework, and develop actionable detections.

My experience includes:

- Conducting threat hunting investigations using Splunk and the BOTS v2 dataset to identify anomalous user behavior, attacker reconnaissance, and Indicators of Compromise (IOCs).
- Performing static malware analysis using REMnux and FLARE-VM to examine executable structure, metadata, imports, strings, capabilities, and potential malicious functionality without executing the sample.
- Performing behavioral malware analysis inside an isolated laboratory using FLARE-VM and REMnux, correlating evidence from Procmon, Process Explorer, Sysmon, Wireshark, Autoruns, Regshot, API Monitor, FakeDNS, and INetSim to investigate persistence, command-and-control communications, process injection, payload retrieval, and simulated data exfiltration.
- Conducting digital forensic investigations with Velociraptor to analyze simulated credential-dumping attacks, collect forensic artifacts, and perform enterprise-wide threat hunting.
- Translating investigative findings into detection content by creating Sigma rules, Splunk SPL queries, Microsoft Sentinel KQL queries, YARA rules, and IOC reports.

I take an evidence-driven approach to investigations, ensuring that every finding is supported by observable artifacts rather than assumptions. This methodology has helped me develop strong analytical skills, attention to detail, and an investigative mindset that aligns well with the demands of modern Security Operations Centers.

Beyond technical investigations, I enjoy documenting my work professionally to demonstrate clear methodologies, reproducible analysis, and practical defensive outcomes. My GitHub portfolio showcases complete investigations, technical reports, detection engineering content, and MITRE ATT&CK mappings that reflect how I approach real-world security problems.

I am eager to bring this mindset, along with my enthusiasm for continuous learning, to a team where I can contribute, grow, and help strengthen an organization's security posture.

Thank you for your time and consideration. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how my background and hands-on experience can contribute to your security team.

Kind regards,

Allen Ace

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